Being sent to prison vastly impacts anyone's life in a negative way, being sent to an adult prison at an age when I should have been attending my sophomore prom in highschool had a life long effect on my future and it was all over Cannabis. I worked hard for the chance to obtain a Highschool equivalency (H.S.E.) but to advance past that, attempting to obtain any form of higher education was nothing but a distant and unattainable dream. The societal ramifications of having a felony conviction for Cannabis has made the prospects of housing, basic living needs, and good employment beyond which in most circumstance and its a domino effect of negativity that always results in incarceration that has cost me 20 years of my life. My current period of incarceration for 21 months is one where my limitations are so severe that the basic elements of self help or education materials are either prohibited from being sent in my correction staff or I am being forced to pay an expensive price to use the very meager education services that are provided. Education and access to liberary resources is the difference between having

a successful plan upon release or entering into society without having the fundamental needs to thrive and succeed met. We need Change to promote Change.

Greg Courtry 2022